



Notification Waiver Determination

EQT Fund Management – Kakaku.com

Acquisition	BPEA Private Equity Fund IX (BPEA IX), through the Japanese special purpose vehicle Kamgras 1 K.K., applied for a notification waiver in respect of its proposed acquisition of all issued common shares and share options in Kakaku.com, Inc. (Kakaku.com), as described in the transaction documents provided as part of the application (the Acquisition).
Determination	The Australian Competition and Consumer Commission has determined under section 51ABV(1)(a) of the <i>Competition and Consumer Act 2010</i> (Cth) that the Acquisition is not required to be notified.
Date of determination	25 May 2026

Parties to the Acquisition	The acquirer, BPEA IX, is a private investment fund controlled by EQT Fund Management S.à r.l. (EQT), its alternative investment fund manager. The target, Kakaku.com, operates online price comparison and consumer information platforms in Japan. Its indirect subsidiary, Time Design International Pte Ltd, incorporated in Singapore, generates commission revenues from Australian customers booking bundled travel packages (such as airline tickets and hotel accommodation) through its technology platform.
Explanation for determination	In making this notification waiver determination, the Australian Competition and Consumer Commission (the ACCC) has considered the information provided with the notification waiver application and had regard to the factors in section 51ABV(2)(b) of the <i>Competition and Consumer Act 2010</i> (Cth) (the Act). Based on the information provided in the application, the ACCC considers that the Acquisition is unlikely to give rise to any material lessening of competition. In particular, there is no horizontal or vertical overlap in Australia between the acquirer (or its connected entities) and Kakaku.com (or its connected entities), including in the supply of online travel booking services. The ACCC has also had regard to the likelihood that, if the Acquisition were put into effect, the notification thresholds determined under section 51ABP(1) of the Act would apply. While the ACCC considers that the notification thresholds are likely to be met, given that material competition concerns are unlikely to arise, the ACCC has determined that the Acquisition is not required to be notified.

	The ACCC considers that the determination is consistent with the object of the Act and the interests of consumers in promoting competition. For more information about the ACCC’s approach to considering notification waiver applications and to assessing competition effects more generally, see the ACCC’s interim guidance on notification waivers and merger assessment guidelines.
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**Determination made by Commissioner Williams pursuant to a delegation under section 25(1)
of the Act**